



The Digital World

A Round-up of Technology News from Across the Globe

CANADA

January 17, police arrested eight men and seized computers and thousands of pictures when they smashed a child pornography ring of unprecedented scale in Ottawa. The Ottawa Police High Tech Crime Unit said officers swooped against an operation to buy child porn over the Internet.

SWITZERLAND

One of the country's two makers of Swiss Army knives is going the tech way. Victorinox is promoting its 'SwissMemory' series, comprising 512 MB 'USB' knives.



RUSSIA

President Putin recently convened a meeting focusing on the creation of technology parks. The Russian IT and communications minister said Russia would invest some \$650 million (Rs 280 crore) in the IT sector in five years.



GERMANY

Metro Group, the world's third-largest retailer, said on January 20 that it had completed the implementation of RFID readers and tags at its largest distribution centre in Germany.

EQUATORIAL GUINEA

A device is being developed that will allow the recording of sophisticated wildlife data on a palmtop. Connected to GPS satellites, it will record the precise location and time of animal sightings. Such data collection could help save endangered species.



SPAIN

Police have arrested a man suspected of writing a virus capable of spying on users through their Webcams. The programmer from Madrid allegedly distributed the virus over a file sharing network.



CHINA

China is fast becoming a nation of prolific Internet users. A recent report says two-thirds of Chinese Internet users will purchase something online this year and young people favour getting their news on the Internet instead of TV.

data in a geographically indexed database.

"MSRI will make much of the government's non-sensitive geographic data available to the public in a format that is easy to browse and comprehend, with intuitive visualisation of data. Eventually, such a system could enable people to exchange information, much like the Internet, but indexed by region and geography," said MSRI managing director P Anandan.

Research for this project will involve work from relevant fields of computer science, including GIS, graphics, user interfaces, spatial databases, image processing and computer vision.

MSRI plans to employ about 24 scientists, interns and support staff in the first year.

MSRI is also initiating several projects in the ICT space by funding university research projects.

"We have selected specific projects through the request for proposal (RFP) process from various institutions across the country and awarded them

\$250,000 (Rs 1.09 crore) in total funding for these projects," added Venkatesan.

Some of the institutions where the projects will be undertaken are Birla Institute of Technology and Science, Pilani; Indian Institute of Information Technology and Indian Institute of Science, Bangalore; and the Indian Institutes of Technology (IITs) in Mumbai, Delhi, Kanpur and Chennai.

Incidentally, China and India are the only two countries outside the US where Microsoft has the entire scale of operations, including software development centres, sales and marketing offices.

ROBO-COLLEGE!

Rocking Robotix

The National Robotics competition of IIT Kharagpur, 'Robotix', held with Kshitij, the annual techno-management festival of



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